GLOBAL MISSING MIGRANTS DATASET

Dataset description, key indicators, and descriptive analysis

1. Dataset description

This report analyses the supplied Global Missing Migrants Dataset CSV. The file contains **13,020 rows** and **19 columns**, covering incident years **2014–2023** across **10 distinct years**. Each row represents a recorded incident or record in the source dataset; it should not automatically be interpreted as one individual person.

What the dataset describes

The fields describe the timing and classification of incidents, origin and incident geography, migration routes, reported outcomes, and the sources used to document incidents. They include incident type and year, reported month, regions and countries of origin, incident region, deaths and estimated missing people, survivors, sex and child counts, cause or description, migration route, location, coordinates, information source, and UNSD geographical grouping.

How to read the records

Counts and totals in this report are calculated from the records and values present in the CSV. Blank values mean information is not recorded in that cell; they should not be treated as zero. The dataset is a reporting source, so observed counts can reflect both incident patterns and differences in documentation or reporting coverage.

Scope and limitations

This is a descriptive analysis, not a causal study. The report does not estimate the probability of death on a route because a valid denominator such as the number of people travelling each route is not provided in the dataset. Some incident totals may be estimates, and overlapping or duplicated records should be checked against source documentation before using sums as official totals.

Dataset profile

Shape: 13,020 records × 19 fields. **Missing cells:** 3,646 (1.47% of all cells). **Exact duplicate rows:** 641.

2. KPI dashboard

The indicators below summarize the size, time coverage, data quality, and most common recorded categories in the supplied file.

Total records	Data fields	Year coverage
13,020	**19**	**2014–2023**
Rows in the CSV	Columns in the CSV	10 distinct incident years

Missing cells	Exact duplicate rows	Top incident region
1.47%	**641**	**North America**
3,646 blank cells	Full-row duplicates	Most common nonblank value

Top migration route	Top cause/description	Top incident type
US-Mexico border crossing	**Drowning**	**Incident**
Most common nonblank value	Most common nonblank value	Most common nonblank value

Reported numeric totals

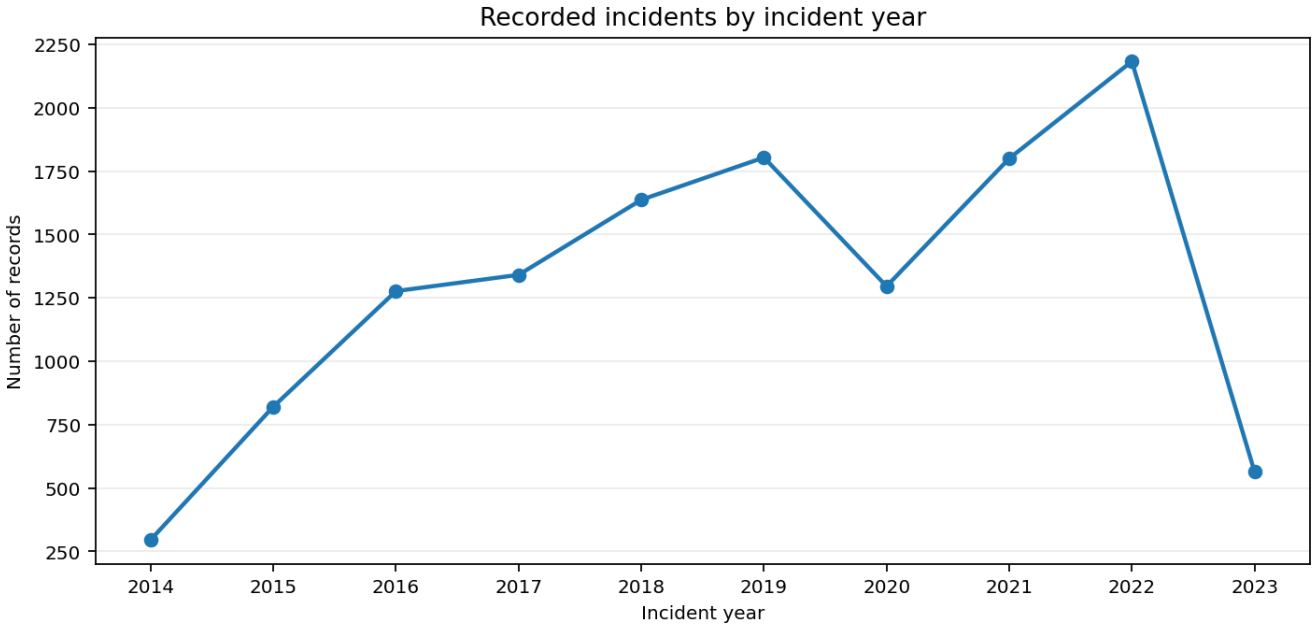
Reported dead: 32,718 **Minimum estimated missing:** 24,795 **Total dead and missing field sum:** 57,513

Reported survivors: 85,330 **Females:** 5,968 **Males:** 14,531 **Children:** 3,100

KPI caution: numeric fields can have missing values and estimates; these sums are raw column sums, not a deduplicated or independently verified count of unique people.

3. Trend over time

The file contains records from 2014 through 2023. The annual chart counts rows by incident year. Peaks and declines may reflect changes in incidents, data collection, source coverage, or a combination of factors.



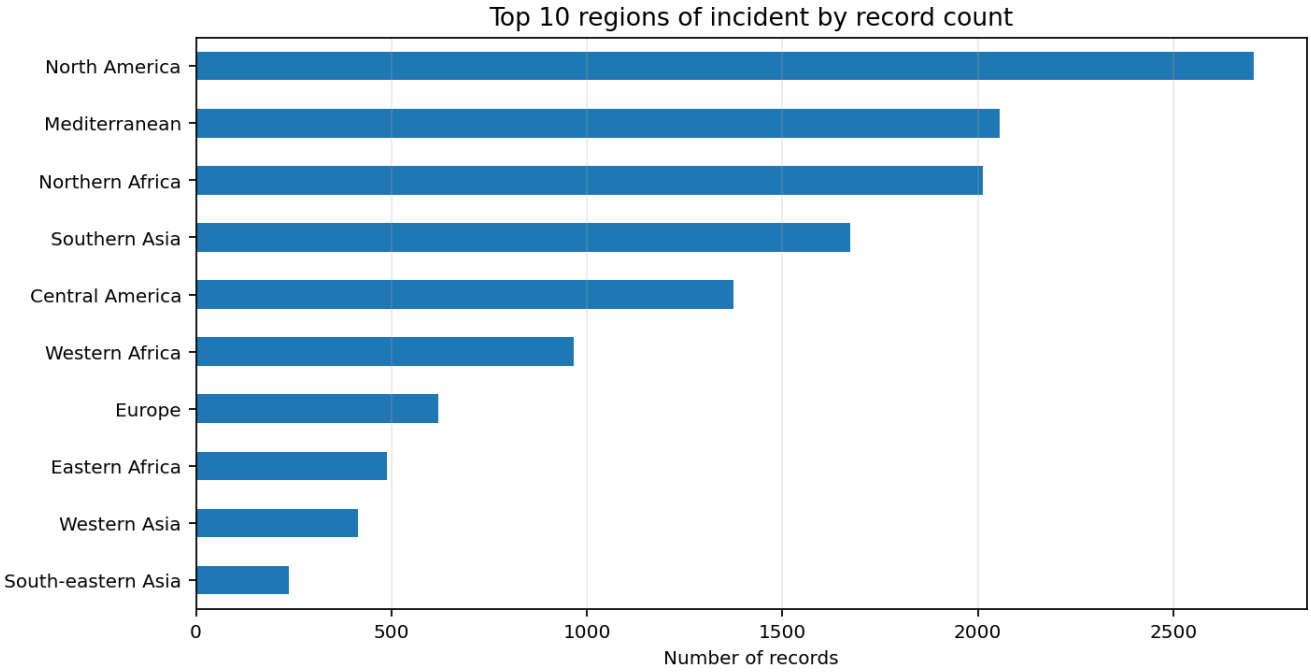
Highest record count: 2022 (2,183 records). **Lowest record count:** 2014 (296 records).

Interpretation

Use this trend to understand how records are distributed over time, not as proof that the true number of incidents rose or fell by the same amount. Confirm reporting completeness and source changes before comparing years.

4. Geographic distribution: incident region

The most frequently recorded incident region is **North America**. The chart shows the ten most common region labels by record count, including a visible Unknown category if present.

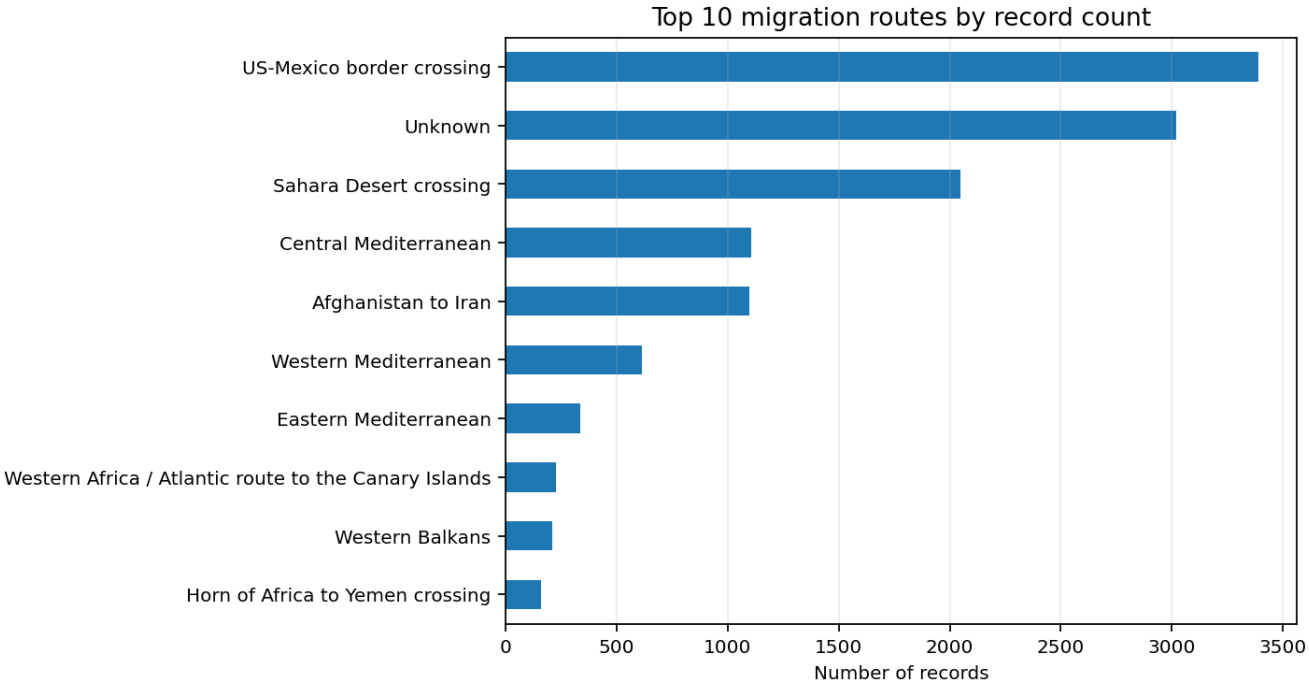


Interpretation

Regional record counts can help identify where reporting and coordination efforts may be useful. They should not be read as comparative danger levels unless differences in exposure, route traffic, and reporting coverage are accounted for.

5. Migration routes

The most frequently recorded route label is **US-Mexico border crossing**. The chart ranks route labels by the number of records associated with each value.



Interpretation

Route categories may vary in specificity and may combine land, sea, border, or other route descriptions. To compare routes responsibly, combine these records with suitable travel-volume denominators and consistent route definitions.

6. Causes and incident descriptions

The most common value in the cause/description field is **Drowning**. The field may contain descriptions at different levels of detail; its labels should be interpreted according to the source's definitions.

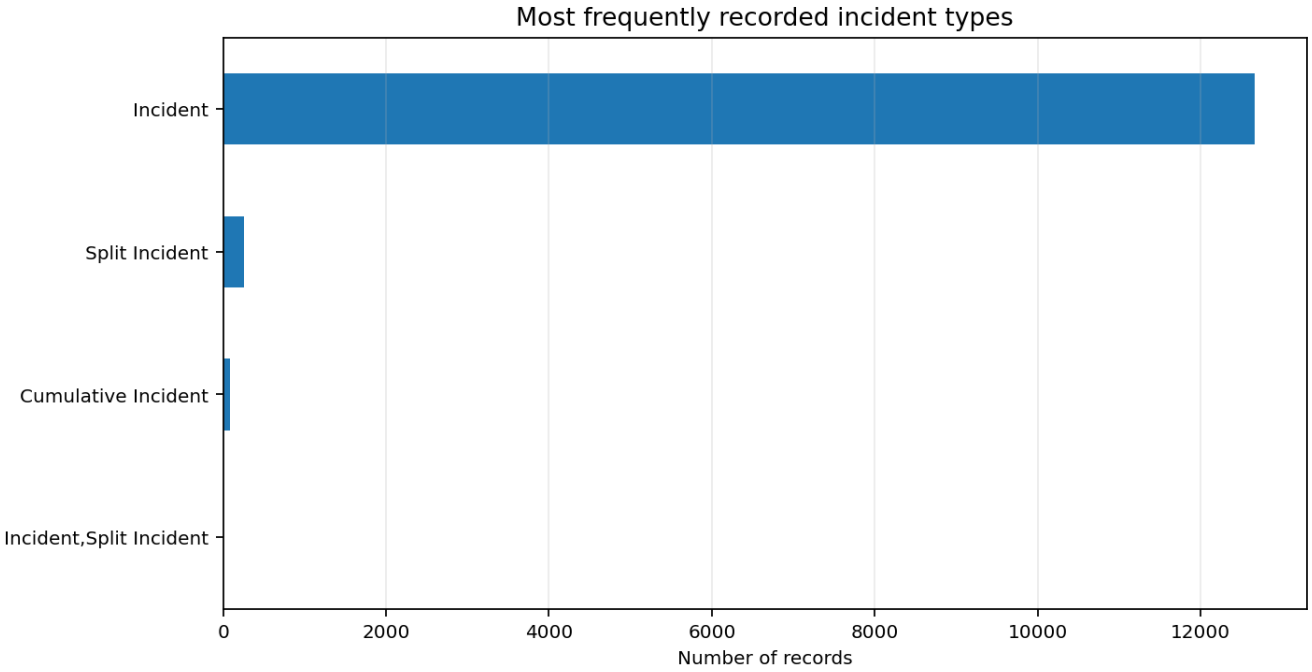


Interpretation

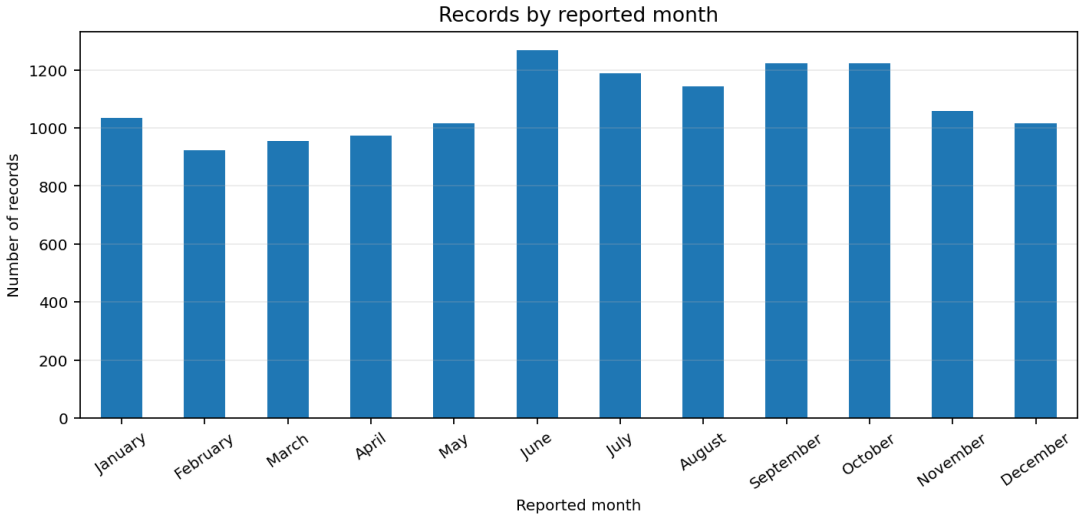
A high count for a category means it appears frequently among the records. It does not necessarily mean the cause is known for all incidents or that all causes were coded consistently. Preserve unknown or uncertain values rather than inferring a cause.

7. Incident type and reported month

The most common incident-type value is **Incident**. These classifications provide another view of how records are categorized in the source file.



Reported month

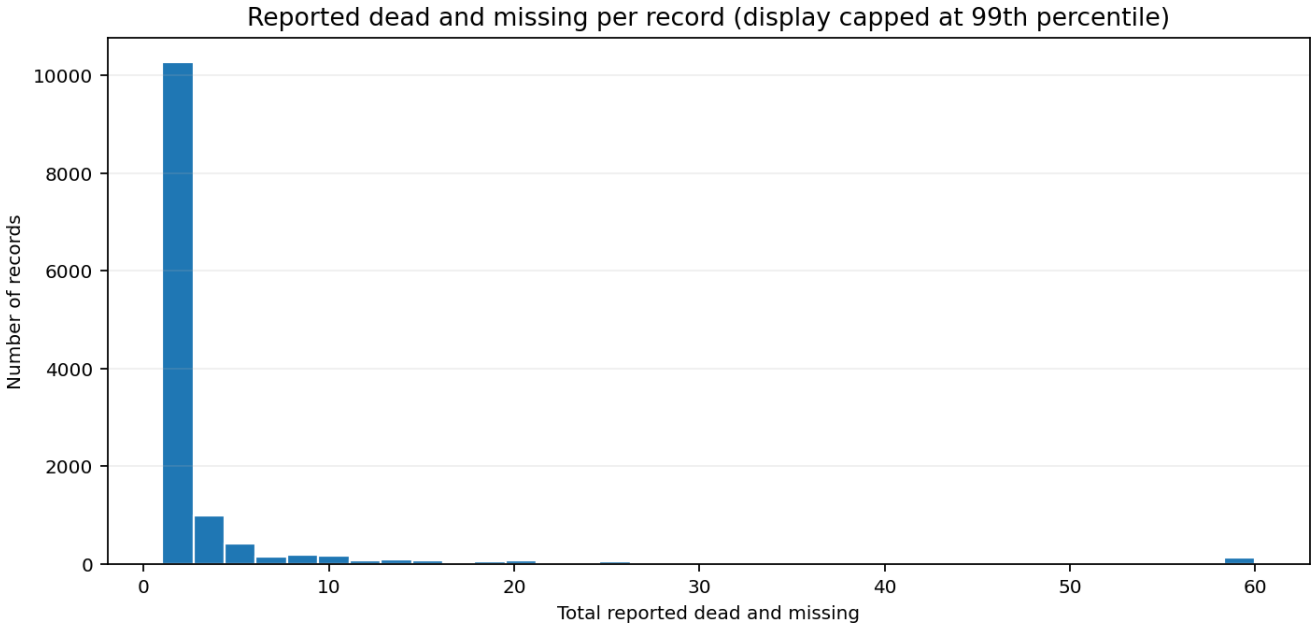


Interpretation

Month counts describe the reported-month field, not necessarily seasonality in underlying incidents. Check whether the field represents incident month or reporting month before drawing conclusions.

8. Reported deaths and missing people

The total-dead-and-missing field has a median of 1 and a mean of 4.42 per record where values are present.



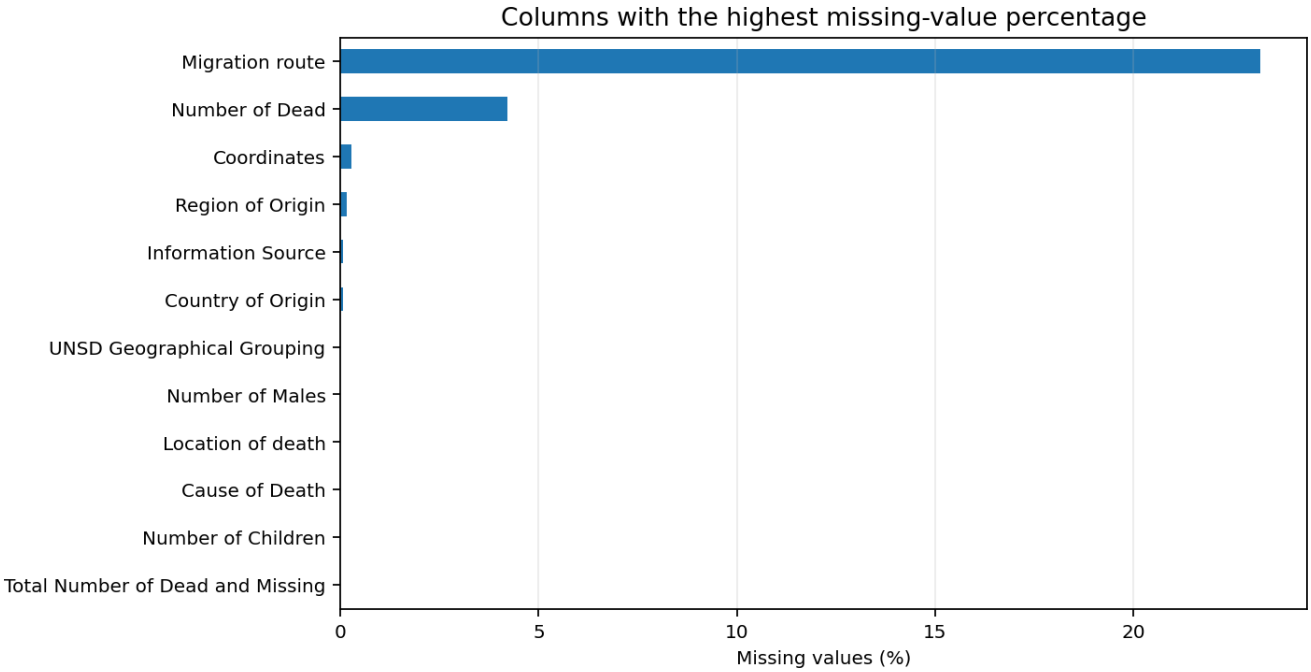
How to read this distribution

The histogram caps values at the 99th percentile for display only, so the central distribution is easier to inspect. The original values are not changed. A small number of large incidents or estimated counts can strongly affect the mean and the total.

Do not add this field to other death or missing fields without confirming whether they overlap; these columns may represent related measures.

9. Data quality and missingness

The dataset has 3,646 missing cells (1.47% of all cells) and 641 exact duplicate rows when all columns are compared. Missingness varies by field.



Recommended data checks

- Inspect duplicate rows against source references before deleting them.
- Distinguish blank values, zero values, and unknown/not applicable values.
- Standardize category spelling and labels before grouping or charting.
- Validate numeric fields and document whether values are estimates or minimums.
- Validate coordinates and coordinate reference assumptions before mapping.

10. Recommendations and methodology

Recommended next steps

1. Build a data dictionary. Document the meaning, allowed values, units, and missing-value conventions for each field.
2. Validate source records. Use incident date, location, information source, and other identifiers to review possible duplicates.
3. Separate descriptive counts from risk measures. Counts by route or region are not rates without an exposure denominator.
4. Improve time-series interpretation. Track changes in sources and reporting coverage over time.
5. Prepare a reproducible pipeline. Keep raw data unchanged, log cleaning decisions, and export a cleaned analysis table separately.
6. Add GIS only after validation. Check coordinate completeness and plausibility before creating maps.

Methodology

This report uses descriptive statistics on the supplied CSV. Category charts show the most frequent recorded labels; annual counts group rows by incident year; numeric summaries use values parsed as numbers; missingness is computed from blank/NA cells; exact duplicates are rows matching across all columns. Charts are placed proportionally to preserve their aspect ratios.

Data limitations

The report does not independently verify source events, deduplicate records by incident identity, infer missing values, or calculate route-specific risk. All findings should be understood as summaries of the supplied file.

Source: Global Missing Migrants Dataset CSV provided for analysis.